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CUSTOM JOURNEY

North East India: Root Bridges and Majuli

6 Nights · 7 Days Homestays, a Trek to Nongriat and the World's Largest River Island

GUWAHATI · MAWLYNNONG · NONGRIAT · SHILLONG · MAJULI · GUWAHATI

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DURATION
6 Nights · 7 Days

ROUTE
Guwahati return

PACE
Active

BEST SEASON
October to April

IDEAL FOR
Solo, Couples

This is the North East as an experience rather than a tour. Six nights, and none of them in a resort: a Khasi homestay in Mawlynnong, a guesthouse by the river in Nongriat at the bottom of three and a half thousand steps, a night in Shillong for its food and its music, and two on Majuli, the largest river island in the world, among the Vaishnavite satras and the mask-makers.

It is the route we recommend to travellers who have done the Kaziranga and Cherrapunji circuit, or who never wanted to, and to anyone whose idea of a journey is a conversation under a tin roof rather than a view from a car window. It asks a little fitness of you and gives back a great deal.

Journey Highlights

- **Stay** with a Khasi family in Mawlynnong, a village so tidy it is called the cleanest in Asia, and eat what they cook under a tin roof.
- **Walk** the living root bridges: the single-decker at Riwai, still growing, and the famous double-decker at Nongriat, reached on foot down a forested valley.
- **Swim** in the natural pools beside the double-decker bridge, with the river running past your guesthouse window that night.
- **Taste** Shillong: jadoh and tungrymbai at a Khasi eatery, and the homegrown indie and rock scene at a music bar in the evening.
- **Cross** the Brahmaputra by ferry to Majuli, the largest river island in the world, and its centuries-old Vaishnavite satras.
- **Sit** with the island's artisans (mask-makers, potters and weavers) and take a boat on the river at sunrise or sunset.

Itinerary at a Glance

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 01	**Guwahati to Mawlynnong**	Into rural Meghalaya; a Khasi homestay
Day 02	**Mawlynnong**	The Riwai root bridge; the bamboo skywalk
Day 03	**Nongriat**	Trek down to the double-decker root bridge
Day 04	**Nongriat to Shillong**	Trek up; Khasi food and Shillong's music
Day 05	**Shillong to Majuli**	By ferry from Nimati Ghat onto the island

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 06	**Majuli**	Satras, artisans and the Brahmaputra by boat
Day 07	**Majuli to Guwahati**	Ferry and road back for the flight

Day by Day

Expand all

Day 01 Mawlynnong: Into the Khasi Hills

Drive · about 4 hours from Guwahati

Land in Guwahati and drive straight into the folds of rural Meghalaya to Mawlynnong, a village so tidy and green that it is often called the cleanest in Asia. Bamboo dustbins line every path, and orchids grow wild along the garden fences. Settle into a homestay with a local Khasi family, sharing meals and stories under a tin roof, and take an evening walk to the village's living root bridges, grown patiently over generations by the Khasi people.

Overnight in a homestay at Mawlynnong

Day 02 Mawlynnong: Village Life at Its Own Pace

A slow, unhurried day to soak in Khasi village life: no rushing between sights, just time to notice the details. Visit the Riwai single-decker living root bridge, still growing stronger with age, and, if you like, climb the bamboo skywalk for a view across the valley to the plains of Bangladesh beyond.

Overnight in a homestay at Mawlynnong

Day 03 Nongriat: Down to the Double-Decker Bridge

Trek · roughly 3,500 steps down from Tyrna

Drive to Tyrna and trek down into a steep, forested valley (roughly three and a half thousand steps) to Nongriat, a village reachable only on foot; the effort is very much part of the reward. The famous double-decker living root bridge is here, two tiers of rubber-tree roots trained across the stream over decades, and the natural pools beside it are for swimming. Overnight in a guesthouse in the village, with the river running just outside your window.

Overnight in Nongriat

Day 04 Shillong: Up from the Valley

Trek · back up to Tyrna, then drive to Shillong

Trek back up to Tyrna and trade the jungle quiet for Shillong's café culture and cooler air. Eat at a Khasi eatery (jadoh, the smoked pork rice, and tungrymbai, the fermented soybean) and in the evening find a table at a music bar: Shillong's homegrown indie and rock scene has a devoted following across the region.

Overnight in Shillong

Day 05 Majuli: Across the Brahmaputra

Boat · Ferry from Nimati Ghat

Travel onward to Majuli, the largest river island in the world, cradled by the Brahmaputra and home to centuries-old Assamese Vaishnavite culture (by road via Guwahati to Jorhat, or with a short flight). Cross by ferry from Nimati Ghat, watching the river widen around you. Visit a satra, one of the island's monasteries, and watch the monks demonstrate traditional mask-making or handloom weaving.

Overnight in Majuli

Day 06 Majuli: Island Rhythms

Boat · Boat ride on the Brahmaputra

A full day given over to island rhythms: river, craft, and quiet conversation with the people who call Majuli home. A boat on the Brahmaputra at sunrise or sunset, the island's fields glowing gold in the low light, and time with the artisans as they work: pottery shaped by hand, masks painted for the satra festivals, cotton woven on traditional looms.

Overnight in Majuli

Day 07 Guwahati: Departure

Boat · Ferry, then 4–5 hours by road

Take the ferry back to the mainland and drive to Guwahati for your onward flight, carrying home a very different picture of the North East.

Departure

Practical notes

Getting there

Guwahati (GAU) is well connected by direct flights from most major Indian cities, and the journey begins and ends there.

Permits

No Inner Line Permit is required for Meghalaya or Assam for Indian nationals. Foreign nationals should check current requirements with us when booking.

Fitness

The Nongriat trek is roughly 3,500 steps down and the same back up, on the following morning. Moderate fitness is needed, and good shoes matter more than anything else you pack.

Best time to visit

October to April. The monsoon from June to September makes the root-bridge trek unsafe and the roads slow, and Meghalaya's rain is the heaviest recorded anywhere.

Style

This route trades comfort for immersion: homestays, a guesthouse and village life over resorts. It is the North East for people who want to be in it rather than look at it.